

ENT105.01:***“Marketing is Everything”*****Wednesdays: 1:20-4:15 PM, JCC 140**

Welcome to ENT 105 for the Fall Semester of 2026! I’m very excited to have you join what is a very unique course at Tufts and within [The Derby Entrepreneurship Center at Tufts](#). Please read this document through immediately since **you have only 5 days to make decisions and submit your first and second choices for your project. If you cannot respond to this time requirement to commit to choosing sign up by the end of the day Friday, June 5th, you will not be allowed to take this course no matter what your registration status is.**

The reason for this requirement is that this is a course where you will be working directly each week with the CEO and VP of Marketing of your selected company. The second reason is that you will be working in a team of five or six and keeping attentive to deadlines is critical to your and your team’s success for this semester.

This is a team-based course with each team consisting of five to six students is assigned to one host company project for the semester. I teach in a manner of “*Content in Context*”. My instructors and our TAs provide the marketing content *within the context* of six marketing projects from real companies. When you commit to this course, you are committed to working both individually and in a team environment totally focused on delivering a marketing plan to your host company at the end of the semester.

- There is a very strong focus on your ability to work in a team environment with tight time requirements.
- During the 13th week of the semester, you and your team will deliver a 90+ minute highly interactive presentation to your management with all your marketing plan materials.
- The management of your company determines 40% of your team grade.

This is a F2F course on Wednesdays from 1:15 to 4:15, Boston time, including a 15-minute break.

- Our outside speakers, all of whom are heavily experienced marketing experts who have graduated from this course, will be a mixture of both live and virtual.
- Weekly Zoom meetings of 30-45 minutes are required between the entire student team and your company management. If you cannot commit to these meetings, please drop this course and let me know right away since I have others on wait lists.

The maximum number of people we can have in the course is 36. I also have an additional wait list from students who have approached me separately since there is no more room to sign up for the registered or the official wait list. I know based on years of experience that there will be a number of changes between now with the first edition of this syllabus and our **first day of class on September 9th**.

This course is heavily focused on learning about the very exciting and rapidly changing world of Marketing, and one of the very critical ingredients of success is your commitment to your teammates, to your clients, to me and our TAs and to yourself about dates and objectives.

Again, if you have any questions at any time, connect with me directly at jack.derby@tufts.edu or 617-504-4222. You can book Teams time with me here: [Book time w/Jack](#)

EXPECTATIONS:

First, thank you very much for registering for this course! It is meant to be a fast-paced, real-life opportunity to:

- Teach you about the strategies and the tactics of what Marketing is in 2026!
- Provide you with the content that you will need to become solid marketing interns.
- Work directly with senior management in delivering their objectives.
- Those objectives will differ significantly for each of the six companies.
- Some will want complete marketing plans, while others will be focused on specific marketing tactics.
- You will be in weekly contact, *just like any consultant*, with management to make sure you are on track.
- Which also means that your team needs to be totally aligned and committed to the project.

What you will be doing during this period of 13 weeks is to clearly understand the needs and objectives of your client and fill those requirements into a carefully constructed tactical marketing plan that will enable your client to create their planned revenue goals for 2027. That revenue objective may take place by selling products or services directly to a specific persona or delivering qualified leads to a sales organization. Over the course of the 12 weeks, (your final presentation will be on the 13th week) you will be learning content from me and our instructors and TAs while and then working among your team members and directly with your client to judge what marketing strategies and tactics will be useful for their company to increase revenue.

On the 13th week of the semester, which will be the second week of December, you will be presenting your final marketing plan to management. Most probably, given the fact that you will have been in weekly contact with your management, there should be very little in terms of your content and solutions that are brand new to your managers. That meeting is the final handing over of your marketing plan and your research that you have worked on during the semester.

Of equal importance, this course is meant to prepare you for your first full-time jobs on leaving Tufts.

- The course is team-based and the majority of your work experience will be team-based.
- It requires tight weekly timetables with specific objectives.
- I regard it as part of my personal responsibility to do whatever I can to help you find jobs that you love!

To that end, you can connect with me at any time to set up individual Team calls: [Book time w/Jack](#)

I want to be respectful of your time so here's how I would read [David Meerman Scott's Book, The New Rules of Marketing](#), which is a requirement read for the course, and, yes, there is a stand up test during the first 20 minutes of our first class. Obviously, I would like you to read the book thoroughly, but if you have any experience in Marketing, you might want to skim the introductory 1/3 of the book. Good things to know, but mostly generalities especially if you have marketing experience.

1. Overall, plan on spending at least 3 hours reviewing the book.
2. **Critical chapters: 1,2,3,4,5,6,8,9,10,12,13,14,15, & 22**
3. At the end, you should be able to provide detailed answers to "What is Inbound Marketing?"
4. **We will have a 20-minute stand up quiz on the book right at the beginning of class.**

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, you will be able to:

- Apply marketing concepts to both early-stage and fast-growth businesses.
- Conduct and interpret market research to create strategy.
- Construct detailed, customized marketing plans for real companies.
- Present insights and specific recommendations to your management.
- Collaborate professionally within diverse teams...just as you will do in your jobs.
- Critically evaluate both strategic direction and tactical execution in marketing contexts

Key Topics Covered

- Marketing fundamentals and decision-making in entrepreneurial environments
- B2B and B2C customer research (primary and secondary)
- Market segmentation and persona definitions
- Detailed value proposition development both for your clients and for you personally
- Marketing process design and sales management
- Go-to-market planning and campaign development.
- Inbound and outbound marketing tactics.
- Pricing strategies and the creation of your marketing budget
- Use of AI and digital marketing tools in marketing planning and execution

Teaching Approach

- Interactive class discussions, case studies, and guest speakers
- Interaction with me anytime and specifically right after Weeks 4, 6 and 9 which are grading weeks.
- Weekly consulting-style project work with real companies.
- Peer and self-assessment to develop team effectiveness.

The Instructors: all our lecturers are Tufts alums from this course. We may not use all of these.

Jack Derby,	Professor of the Practice, jack.derby@tufts.edu Cell: 617-504-4222
Stacey Brownlie,	Student Success Librarian at Tisch Library
Abby Curran,	Director of Pricing, Dialpad , and an alum lecturing on pricing.
Abem Fetene	Google AI specialist and an alum from this class.
Abha Gallewale,	Prior Global Strategy Manager, ASICS , and an alum from this class
Caroline Gingold,	Venture Capital Investor, Clear Haven Partners, and an alum from this class
Max Kind	Tufts Instructor defining the marketing metrics of CAC and LTV.
David Kunen	Career Guidance in Product Management: Engineering, Marketing, Product?
Maureen Li:	Digital Marketing Emerson Health on Omni Channel Marketing, an alum from this class
Zach Merchant,	Reporter/Anchor, 11Alive, Atlanta, an alum from this class
Cory Peterson	VP Sales & Marketing, LED
Ramiro Sarabia,	Brand Mgr, prior Facebook & TikTok, an alum on ad buying.
David Meerman Scott	World Renowned Author, Speaker, Marketing Genius

Please note that in anything related to registration of your ID numbers, you need to connect with [Peter Om](#) , Tufts Program Coordinator. For general questions regarding the course or the Derby Entrepreneurship Center, connect with [Carol Denning](#), the Assistant Director of the Derby Entrepreneurship Center, at carol.denning@tufts.edu.

Given the complexity of this course, and the fact that it is team-based, and that the teams are working with the senior management of real companies who have signed up for the delivery of marketing plans from you, we have a few TAs working with you and your team. Of course, I am always available to assist with whatever you need.

Office Hours: Please make appointments by email or text with either me or your TA, and we will set something up immediately to work within your schedule. I can also be reached by phone most days up to 6:00 PM, If that does not work for you, just let me know, and I will accommodate your time. Very simply, you are my priority, so never apologize for connecting with me. Just text or email me to set a time for your call. One of the many Derby Rules: ***“When in doubt, text, email or call me anytime and ask”.*** You can also sign up directly through any of my email signatures that also contain my **“Book Time with Jack”** calendar. I also encourage you to set up individually scheduled meetings with me either F2F or more easily and more quickly by Zoom/Teams. This is your opportunity for individual feedback and any questions of any kind.

There is a requirement to have the full team meet with me and your TA outside the classroom for 30-45 minutes during the 4th , 7th and 9th weeks of the semester.

One of the most important and most infamous is ***“The Derby Rule”*** for all classes and all students: **Any student late to any class after the appointed times for the beginning of class or from breaks, owes the Class Reception Fund \$5.00.**

There are never any exceptions to ***The Derby Rule***, and, yes, it is strictly enforced. ***It’s a very simple rule: Come late to class and you owe \$5.00 that goes to the end-of-semester lunch fund!*** This course is designed to put you immediately into the real world of business and prepare you for your first corporate job. In the real world...” ***Showing up on time for meetings is showing up 15 minutes early!”***

To make showing up early for class more impactful, at the beginning of every class, I will review the details of any job openings I've received during the prior week, sometimes bringing online for two minutes, the hiring managers from those companies.

Last semester the majority of students who wanted part-time or full-time jobs that were related to this course in Sales, Marketing or Product Management positions, were able to receive offers through these connections made through this course. In addition to learning about the exciting and rapidly changing world of Marketing and developing complete marketing plans for your companies, there is a major emphasis placed on [click for your free copy] ["The Marketing of Me"](#) and providing you with specific opportunities for exciting and high paying jobs and internships.

Course Description

This course covers the most essential, the most critical and often times the most difficult building block of what it takes to create successful companies of any size in any market, and that is Marketing, which is at the very core of any company's success.

Top 6 Requirements for a successful semester

1. Read and abide by this syllabus. I would expect one or two revs of this before January 14th.
2. If you have any questions of any kind at any time, contact me or your TA.
3. Actively *engage* in our classes and in your own team.
4. If you feel you are having difficulty in class or in your team, reach out to me or your TA.
5. This course is a formal partnership between me and you. You need to be a *very* engaged partner.
6. If you feel that the course is lacking, or going too fast or too slow, just speak up and tell me!

The course is designed to provide six essential components:

1. Teach detailed tactical fundamentals of Marketing in the real world of 2026.
2. Create real-life marketing plans for existing companies. Just like an internship...*because it is*.
3. Engage in interactive class discussions and debate both in class and in your teams.
4. Deliver an HBS case study analysis presenting your detailed recommendations.
5. Collaborate actively with your team providing research, analysis, and detailed recommendations.
6. Provide personal career development and job-hunting skills.

I have only two objectives this semester:

1. Teach and engage you in the very exciting and rapidly changing world of Marketing.
2. Provide you with guidance and connections to market yourself and obtain exciting high-paying jobs that you love! It's up to you to land the job. I can kick open a lot of doors, and many of those doors are from my alums who have taken my courses who want to give back hiring student interns and recent Tufts grads.

Course objectives and teaching methods:

The major building blocks of this course, **starting on September 9th** are:

- Six team-based, semester-long marketing projects are provided for teams consisting of four to six students. Each team selects one project, which is worked on by you and your teammates directly with the senior management (typically the CEO or VP of Marketing of the company). It is required that you meet with management each week for 30-45 minutes initially to ask questions and then to keep them up to speed with your progress over the period of the semester.

At the end of the semester, the team will then turn over their documented marketing and research materials with a detailed marketing plan to management in a 90-minute presentation. 40% of your grade related to the project will be decided by the management of your company grading you and your team as to how well you completed and met their objectives over the course of the semester. The other 60% of your course grade will be determined by me and your TA.

The specific objectives of each project are customized to the objectives given to each team by their company management. That person is typically the VP of Marketing and/or the CEO of the company.

These objectives typically include.

- Extensive secondary and primary market research including customer surveys.
- Pricing analysis
- Competitor analysis
- Development of specific Personas
- Development of the Value Propositions for those Personas
- Inter-related tech tools whether those are using HubSpot, which we use, or other platforms.
- The hands-on use of customized AI in the development of your tactics and research.

Whatever the objectives are, they will then be summarized in a comprehensive marketing plan delivered at the end of the semester. You will be providing a detailed tactical marketing plan with specific, actionable recommendations including “how-to” tactics along with their related budgets and potential hiring plans if necessary. The work that you have done each week with your management over the 12 weeks and then delivered in this final marketing plan on Week 13 is the summation of the semester. To make this more “real” and therefore more meaningful to you and your client, management provides 40% of your team grade.

That final presentation to your management must be made sometime during the first week of December. I will attend as will your TA. Experience has shown that given everyone’s end of the semester schedules, you need to schedule this time with your management and with me and your TA no later than the mid-term exam on October 14th since there will be many competing times for locations.

- There will be a presentation in Week 4 following your Discovery meeting.
- There will be a longer presentation in Week 6 as the midterm.
- There will be a 15-minute defense of a Harvard Business School case study that is team-based.
- There is the final 90-minute presentation in first week of December.

You will be meeting with your company management during class time on September 23rd. This is the very critical “Discovery Meeting” when you will meet F2F with your management as a team and finalize all the objectives for your project. It is the success of meeting these objectives against which your work will be measured and graded.

This meeting on September 23rd is actually the “final” meeting to lock down all the objectives. Long prior to this meeting and as soon as you have been approved by me for your project choice, you should start reviewing the company’s site, investigating their markets, and learning about their competitors...all of which will be easy to do online. At the end of our first class on September 9th, you will be contacting your management and scheduling your weekly review meeting time. You will meet for a short period of 30-45 minutes with your management every week to ask more questions and just to keep them up to date.

It is not uncommon that you or some members of your team will reach out to management over this summer break period just to introduce yourself and ask about the company...*just like any good consultant would do...* since in working in this course, you have taken on the immediate responsibility of becoming a marketing consultant. Once you get approved by me for your project, you can reach out directly to your management contact before the course begins, and/or just contact me with any questions at any time. That reachout does not have to be long and can just be an introduction and that you’re looking forward to working with them this semester. In a few cases, students have ended up doing internships for the client before the course ends.

Best Success Practices:

- Required active involvement in our weekly classroom discussions. Your “active engagement” in the class discussion represents 20% of your final grade. That 20% will be determined by me and your TA.
- Consistent weekly active engagement with your teammates, your TA and me.
- Weekly full-team meeting with your management with a submitted agenda and timelines each week.
- Success in the mid-term, the case study and most importantly your final presentation materials.
- Continuous discussions regarding your job searches and delivering your own Value Propositions. Everyone will present their own personal Value Proposition in a 90 second presentation to the entire class for feedback.
- Required at the end of the semester is a one-page confidential course evaluation of your performance, your personal evaluation of your team, the project, and the overall course.

Your first assignment is due right now! (1) send me a short bio of who you are, (2) why you are taking this course, (3) your marketing experience as defined by “none”, “some”, “medium”, or “high” so that I can balance the projects and (4) your first and second choices for the companies you are choosing.

My very best Marketing students send me a short video! We will collect all the bios and send them to everyone in the course before class begins.

Attached to the email of this syllabus are the outlines of the six companies and their project objectives for the semester. Do some research, make two choices, a first and a second, and email **me no later than 6:00**

PM June 5th in order to remain in the class!

Failure to complete this first assignment means you will be dropped from the course no matter what your status is since it shows me that you are not serious about the course, and that there is a risk of you letting your team down on a semester filled with critical time-sensitive dates.

Summaries of these companies are attached to this email. Do some research. email or call me with questions, and we will set up a quick call to immediately discuss. Each of these projects is purposefully very different in terms of their products, the company size, and the specifics of management's objectives since it gives all of us a unique opportunity to learn about different industries.

Each project is very exciting and, most importantly, each project is purposefully needed by their management. In each of these companies, they could have hired a marketing agency or a consulting company to do this work. Management has decided to hire us since they have learned of our expertise and the very positive results we deliver from our hundreds of successes. None of the management in these companies is coming to us because they want to be nice to Tufts students. They are literally hiring us because we are (or will become shortly) professional marketing consultants tactically equipped with today's marketing tools to provide their companies with increased leads which will lead to increased revenue for their companies.

Please note that the objectives of your project will most probably change somewhat from what is being sent here in this syllabus based on the interaction of you and your team with the management of your companies once you start working with them. It is the team's responsibility to anticipate changes in their objectives, and each week during your check-in calls, verify that you are on track (or not) with the project's objectives.

These companies will be discussed very briefly during the initial class of the semester. Your job is to do research on these companies **NOW** and select the company you want to work with. Both the selection of the individual projects and your individual team members is done on a first come/first served basis, **but** I reserve the right to make changes based on the backgrounds of your bios since I need to make sure that every team is balanced in terms of experience.

If you have questions about the class, its time, its rules, and the fact that you might have time logistics issues during this semester that will cause conflicts, text, or email me now, and we'll set up a time to talk on the phone as soon as you can.

The Six Companies

Attached to this email are the detailed objectives directly provided by company management. If you want, prior

to the semester beginning, I can also provide more detailed information. You can contact your management directly at any time once you have been confirmed that you are officially on the team. Take a look at the brief attachments to the email that is sending you this syllabus, and you will find the outlines of their objectives. These will be added to with potential changes up to the time the course begins. Right now, I am sending you the six companies I have selected from a list of 17.

CREO Advisors: Creo Advisors is a boutique strategy and growth-focused advisory firm that helps Private Equity firms, middle-market companies, and large corporations create lasting value. Our work spans strategy design to execution, from strategic planning and EBITDA improvements to go-to-market execution and organizational capability-building for clients.

Crosscheck bridges the gap between insight and action in quality assurance. By combining a QA intelligence platform with independent, on-site evaluators, CrossCheck identifies hidden performance gaps and delivers actionable insights that improve guest experience, operational efficiency, and compliance. Fortune 500 companies across corporate dining, healthcare, higher education, and senior living trust CrossCheck to validate performance, strengthen accountability, and drive continuous improvement.

EntoCellular: An early-stage spinout of the Kaplan Lab at Tufts University, based on 8+ years of PhD research, We produce EntoProtein, a whole cell biomass ingredient that is an alternative to farmed animal products in pet food. In the U.S. alone, pets are responsible for 1/3 of meat consumption. While meat has important nutritional value for pets, meat *production* is rife with environmental, ethical, and safety (e.g., avian flu!) challenges. Further, we are simply not producing enough meat to feed the growing pet population. Pet producers are looking for alternatives to diversify their animal protein portfolio, and EntoCellular is poised to supplement the growing need for real animal protein produced without farming animals. <https://www.linkedin.com/company/entocellular/>

Expressit Delivery: a family-owned, woman-led logistics company approaching 45 years in business. We operate in a space dominated by large, transactional players, but we've built this differently. We don't think of ourselves as just a delivery vendor. We act as a true partner to our clients - working closely with their teams, solving problems in real time, and helping them deliver a better experience to their customers.

PlaneSense: A leading fractional aircraft ownership company serving individuals, families, and businesses that value private aviation access, operational excellence, and highly personalized service. With a fleet of Pilatus PC-12 and PC-24 aircraft, PlaneSense offers a differentiated model in the private aviation market:

VetMotl: An artificial insemination business for cattle, pigs and horses led by [Bill Sharp](#), a very successful entrepreneur in a related business, and his VP of Marketing. We just completed a project for this company in the Spring 2026 semester, and this will be a continuation and deeper dive into those objectives attached here.

By the end of the first class on **September 9th**, the project details and the teams will be finalized. After the first class, and no later than that Friday, **the 11th**, one or both of the Team Co-Captains will contact your company's manager and introduce the team. On the third class of this course, **on September 23rd**, you will be meeting F2F with your senior management contact either on campus or at the company if they are local. If you do decide to

visit the company, send me receipts for any expenses that you incurred, and I will reimburse you directly. We strongly encourage F2F visits at any time, not just on this Discovery Day of September 23rd.

This meeting on **September 23rd** is one of ***the most critical meetings of the semester!*** You will:

- **Get answers to every possible question you can! There are no questions you should not ask!**
- Finalize all the objectives of your project since your project will be measured against these objectives.
- **“Discover”** everything about the company that you have not already done research on.
- Everything you do during the following 10 weeks will be measured against the objectives of this meeting.
- For this meeting you will have already researched the markets and their competitors
- If any primary research is required, this meeting will define the details that you will need to do .

This meeting also confirms the timing and the objectives of your 30-minute weekly meetings with your management. It's our experience that the more detailed and more probing these meetings are in the first half of the semester between the student team and management, the more successful the projects are in December. Frequency, detail and asking questions creates a direct correlation to A+ grades!

Your TAs for this semester are all A+ students, heavily experienced individuals who have previously taken this course. Rely on their experience and their active involvement during the semester. Each will also teach portions of the course.

Assignments:

1. **Most importantly**, you have **until the end of the day, June 5th**, to get me your bio including whether you have any marketing or sales experience and your first two choices for projects. If you cannot do this, it tells me that you're not going to be able to keep pace with your team and the required course work.
2. **Define your experience level as “None, Some, Medium, or Heavy”!**

There are reading assignments outlined below for this class. Please come to the first class prepared to discuss the **Inbound Marketing** concepts, strategies, and tactics outlined in David's book. **You must read David Meerman Scott's book The New Rules of Marketing & PR 9th Edition in prep for the first class on September 9th. Make sure that you read the 9th Edition, which was new in 2024. Yes, there will be a stand-up quiz so don't embarrass yourself or your team.**

I want to be respectful of your time during your summer break, so here's how I would read David's book. Obviously, I would like you to read the book thoroughly, but if you have any experience in Marketing, you might want to skim the introductory portion of the book.

-Overall, plan on spending at least 4 hours reviewing the book.

- At the end, you should be able to provide **detailed** answers to “What is Inbound Marketing?”
- We will have a 15-minute stand-up Q&A about the book at the very beginning of our first class.

It’s a great book, easy-to-read, and it’s impossible for you not to become a strong Inbound Marketing intern the time you will spend with this book. Failure to at least read this book superficially will leave you not only embarrassed during our first class, but, more importantly, seriously behind in terms of the detailed concepts of Inbound Marketing, which is the primary foundational focus for success during this course. David will come to class later in the semester to lead us through a discussion of what he is experiencing in Marketing in 2026.

HubSpot: HubSpot is a marketing and sales software company headquartered in Cambridge, and it is integral to this course and to your success as a Certified Marketing Consultant. HubSpot created the concept of “Inbound Marketing”, the hottest and fastest growing trend in marketing over the past ten years. Inbound consists of 3 primary categories: (1) Blogging, (2) social media, and (3) SEO. During the semester, you will be expected to become an expert in the use of each of these three categories. Hubspot is also always listed as “The #1 Best Place to Work in the Large Tech Company Category”. 130+ of my personal alums from this class currently work there, some of whom you will meet as instructors. We use their marketing software platform, and its blogging, social and SEO tools are integral to this course. Each team will receive HubSpot software licenses when class begins so that you can begin using their software.

HubSpot certification is required prior to the second class on September 16th in order to be allowed to continue with the course. No certification/you will be dropped from the course! **Last semester 96% of the students were certified before the semester began.** You will have a serious jump in the class and your projects if you get certified before the course begins. All video instruction with integrated short questions and then a final test. It takes a bit of time, but it is invaluable and is absolutely required for this course. For some of the projects- VetMotl, CREO and PlaneSense are examples, the companies are already using Hubspot.

To begin your HubSpot Inbound Marketing certification, start here: [Inbound Marketing](#). We will also refer to the **[HubSpot Academy](#)**. It is your best source for all things HubSpot.

Market Research

For those companies requiring market research, we will cover the fundamentals in our second class. Both Secondary and Primary Research are integral to your success for your client. You will meet an exceptional talent in Stacey Brownlee during our second class. Most importantly, please reach out to her during the semester since both secondary and primary research is **absolutely** integral to your and your client’s success.

[\(4\) Stacey Brownlie | LinkedIn](#)
[Stacey Brownlie | Tisch Library](#)

Grading:

- **25%: Classroom Participation.** This is an individual assessment by me and your assigned TA of your skills, attitudes, individual leadership and the amount and quality of your class participation plus the degree of your engagement and innovation in working on your project and within your team.

- **5%: September 30th:** A 10-minute presentation detailing your Discovery Meeting the week before.
- **15%: A PowerPoint Mid Term Presentation on October 14th** by each team to your fellow classmates. This presentation will serve as a mid-term checkpoint since we will now be 50% through the semester. In addition to a detailed and well executed presentation, each team is required to write a one-page constructive critique of one another's team progress report and send it to each Team Captain, the TAs and to me no later than **6:00 PM on October 16th**. Each team will provide the rest of the class with a concise, well-rehearsed and tightly packaged 15-minute presentation outlining the company, the project objectives, your current status, the timelines and specifically any concerns that the team is having with the project.

This presentation will be graded by me and our TAs, and team grades for these presentations will be based on (1) an assessment of your project six weeks into the semester and (2) the content provided along with your actual presentation process. What we will be looking for is the amount of detail, analytical contribution, objective assessment, specific recommendations, and actual progress made 50% into the semester by the team. An excellent, constructive presentation of each team and positive peer assessments means that the individual members of the team will all do well. A very general overview with nothing but vague comments will result in only average grades, *at best*, for everyone on the team. More importantly, a weak presentation tells me that there has been a problem in the team and its coordination with the management of the company.

- **10%: The Harvard Business School Case Study – “Calm vs. Headspace”:**
Grading for this case study will focus heavily not only on “the obvious” issues in the case studies, but also to what degree the team did specific research outside of the specifics of the case into the general market issues and analytics of the particular industry and utilized that information in their case study presentations. The intent of this study is to promote *your* ideas either as individuals or as a team. The objective is not to parrot back the content of the case and repeat what is already there. To some degree, there are no right or wrong answers to these case studies. What we are really looking for each team to do is to promote their own ideas. In fact, I may not agree with your thoughts, which is fine, and we can then enter into a debate about why you have made a specific recommendation.
- **35% will be graded by the management team of your project based on the final presentations and material turned over to management at the end of the semester.** During that first week of December, each team will have 90 minutes to make their presentations and present their marketing plan while handing over all the documentation and research materials to their company's management. This is a fully documented Marketing Plan with research in text with whatever materials have been developed over the course of the prior 12 weeks. In all cases, by the time of the actual final presentations, the management of the company should be *almost* fully aware of what will be presented since ostensibly the teams have been working closely with the company management every week over the course of the semester.

Although the most important specific deliverable of this semester is the actual submission of the final written product along with the PowerPoint presentations made at the end of the semester, you and your team will be heavily graded on your capabilities to:

- Plan this project from beginning to end. The planning timelines are critical to your success!
- Provide an analytical assessment of your company's issues and opportunities.
- Conduct market and customer research and provide conclusions and insights from your work.
- Provide detailed recommendations of tactical solutions.

- Utilize the marketing tools that we have discussed in class.
- Provide usable examples of personas, value propositions, SEO, AI, social media, blogs, events, and budgets.

The management of each of these companies have committed time to assure the success of these projects. Each of these managers, very much like you, lead complex lives with business pressures to achieve their business objectives. As a result, at various times, you may find it difficult to track them down and get answers to your questions. That having been said, it's the total responsibility of the team to not let your weekly schedules slip. Weekly check-in client meetings are a requirement.

Your TA and I can provide tactics to help you if you get stuck, so connect with us right away if this occurs. Time will work against you if you get behind in these projects. In all cases, I am ***always*** available since each of these companies has been specifically researched and selected by me and in most instances, are well known by me either as customers or investments. **Never apologize for calling me or emailing/texting me at any time.** In general, I am available from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM 5 days a week and Saturday mornings and can be easily scheduled by using my "Book Time" in my emails.

Final Self-Evaluation Paper

Following the final company project presentations at the end of the semester, each team member will be required to submit their own one-page *confidential-to-me-only* critique of how they felt that their team worked throughout the semester and provide any recommendations for improvement in the course or in its structure. This evaluation will cover improvements to the course and the team participation outside the classroom.

Required Reading Materials

Canvas: All course lectures, which will typically be delivered in PowerPoint format and will be posted on Canvas on the Sunday prior to Wednesday's class. Canvas also contains information regarding a variety of Marketing tools and presentation criteria.

My ebook ["Writing the Winning Marketing Plan in 2026"](#) will provide the foundation of the outline of your actual marketing plan. For some companies, this total structure will be required, while for others, only certain components. It all depends on the objectives of your company.

For those of you looking for a job, you are not required to read ["The Marketing of Me"](#), but I know from 100's of examples, that this step-by-step process works most of the time. You can set up separate meetings with me, and we can walk through the science of the process.

Class Participation:

You are expected to be proactive, questioning and contributing in class with your fellow students and with me. What I am looking for is ***your point of view***, and in many cases, in this rapidly changing new world of Marketing, it may well be that *there is neither a right nor a wrong way*. Marketing today is more of a series of timed experiments all intertwined with a significant amount of market surveys, social campaign testing, persona identification and value propositions and deep analytics and metrics.

25% of your grade is based on my and the TAs perception of your active engagement in the class. 25% is very

significant and without active contribution on your part during class and in your team, plus regular attendance, even if your team assignment is graded as an “A”, lack of individual participation in class or in your team, will easily dilute an “A” to a “B” and perhaps even to a “B-”.

The judgement of class participation is made by me and our highly experienced TAs, all of whom have taken this course previously and received an A+ grade. I point this out very specifically here since several students complain to me each semester after their final grades are posted that the rest of their team received an “A” or an “A-”, but they only received a “B+”. My response is always the same: *“Do the math, that’s what the 25% is”*. Specifically, there should not be any surprises to grades less than an “A” since we will have had an individual discussion or two regarding class participation. A key determinant in your active engagement in the course is your ability to meet weekly as a team and with your company management.

Having said that, ***if you are having difficulty of any kind*** during the class, especially during the initial one or two classes, call me or email to arrange a F2F or Zoom meeting or a call. I and our TAs will always work with you if you, or I, or they feel that you are not participating in the class sufficiently. Also, if you do not personally feel that I am paying enough attention to you, or that I am not calling on you enough or involving you in the class discussions, please do not hesitate to point this out to me at any time.

I also recognize that I talk a lot and tend to repeat myself and sometimes can be abrupt. If that’s the case, let me know either directly in class or in a side meeting. That’s the other half of this two-way partnership between you and me that we need to achieve in this course. Also, please let me know confidentially in the first or second class if you have any hearing, eyesight or language issues or any learning disabilities.

Use of Zoom/Team/Google

This course is live and in person. If you are ill and therefore cannot attend class F2F, first you must let me and your TA know with an email, and second if you could attend by Zoom, we would appreciate your attendance, especially with our guest lecturers. Many of our guest speakers, who are local, will be live in class. At any time, if you are having problems of any kind, just contact your TA right away. When you are using zoom, you **must** use the video function to make sure that we maximize the humanity of participating in class.

Important Notice:

As much as this course is about content, it is also heavily focused on providing you with real-life work experience, my own references and opening doors to potential employers for both internships and full-time jobs. Given that focus on the real world, all team and individual assignments are to be handed in by email on the required due dates, exactly as you will be required to do in your job when you commit to deadlines from your management.

Any paper or presentation not handed in on time will be considered late and simply not read. I well understand that you are under pressure from your heavy course workload, but balancing workloads is part of what you will

be required to do every day in business and in your personal lives, so to be fair to everyone, **a late submission of a paper or presentation will lose 100% of its related grade. This will apply to the entire team, not only to the person who was supposed to deliver the paper.**

There are no exceptions to this policy. No excuses for computers breaking down or you were locked out of your room or anything else. That's why you have a team. 100% is 100%. Absence from class, for any reason ***other than*** a doctor's note, during any of the classes will weigh heavily against the individual student in grading.

Again, always reach out to your TA making sure that they know since they are responsible for identifying whether you attended class or not. We use your weekly picking up of your tent cards with your names as part of our keeping attendance.

AI Tools: more and more, success in Marketing today is your ability to be fluent in your use of AI tools. While we will focus on using the embedded AI tools within HubSpot, I am a strong advocate of the larger platforms of GPT-4, Claude and Copilot especially since I work in MS platforms all the time. I tend to use Claude for real time web search and also its ability to access my work data in HubSpot.

Since we use HubSpot, my recommendations are to use Hubspot Academy to learn more about specific recommendations for Marketing use of AI:

[HubSpot - Academy](#): A highly recommended introduction video: AI as a strategic advantage

AI Tips for Success

- Use AI to brainstorm, not to replace your thinking.
- Validate outputs-AI can be wrong or biased.
- Pair AI with your TA's feedback for stronger deliverables.
- Disclose and cite sources when using AI for research.
- Be very careful about confidentiality-Never put client data into public tools.
- Practice your presentations with AI-generated Q&A simulations.
- Use AI to rehearse your "Marketing of Me" pitch and refine your delivery.
- What you must do in your use of AI is to not violate the university's [Academic Integrity](#) policies.

In the schedule below, there are 3 Presentations prior to the final presentation:

- **Week 4: 10-minute presentation on the results of your Discovery Meeting the week before**
- **Week 6: Mid term**
- **Week 8: Harvard Case Study**
- **Week 13 Final Presentation**

In each of these, you will need to present an agenda and how the team is going against your timeline.

Final Thoughts...

This course requires a lot of complex work. It is meant to be fast paced, filled with content and analytics, and highly focused on providing real life learning situations and directly working with you to open doors for full time jobs and internships.

You work hard, I am 100% committed to opening doors for you in my companies, with my alums and with other Tufts connections.

In several instances, prior students have gone on to work for the project team companies either as interns or employees. I am very excited about the opportunity to work with you this semester!

Jack's Cell: 617-504-4222,

jack.derby@tufts.edu

Professor of the Practice, [Derby Entrepreneurship Center@Tufts](#)

Date	Primary Topics of Discussion	Deliverables *** Due for Class ***
September 9th	-What are The New Rules of Marketing & PR -Syllabus / Course Logistics -“What is Marketing?” -What are the ethical boundaries of AI in Marketing? -Should you tell your clients your using AI generation -Let’s do “A 15-minute Pricing Exercise.” -What are Business Plans or Sales & Marketing Plans -Hubspot Personas & Value Propositions - SWOT Introduction	Completed at least a 4-hour read of “New Rules of Marketing & PR” and bring the book to class. Ideally, you would read the entire book. You must be prepared to answer in detail the question of “<i>What is Inbound?</i>” Most everyone should be Hubspot Inbound Marketing Certified by this time and must be by the next class! HubSpot - Academy introduction.
September 16th Class #2	1.Preparation for your February 4th visits -How to do your “Discovery Meeting” on the 4th. -Ask Hubspot’s AI tool about Discovery best practices 2.At 2:00 Fundamentals of Market Research with AI Stacey Brownlie, Student Success Librarian! 3. 1 of the 10 Rules for the Best Presentations “Do not present but engage and share.”	-Must have your Inbound Marketing certification! -How to add Personas through Hubspot -Using AI, create a preliminary persona. -Which companies need to complete Primary Research? -You need to use AI for basic research before this class -What have you found out about your company? -What are basic primary market issues and questions? -“A Practical Guide to Primary Research, right after Step 1 in this workbook: Aulet, B. (2017). Disciplined entrepreneurship workbook (M. Ursache, Ill.; C. Snyder, Ed.). John Wiley and Sons, Inc. -A more in-depth treatment: Chapter 3 of Cheek, P., & Aulet, B. (2024). Disciplined Entrepreneurship Startup Tactics: 15 Tactics to Turn Your Business Plan into a Business (1st ed.). Wiley. -short video is part of a lecture series in one of streaming video subscription platforms: Knowledgemotion Ltd., film distributor, & Business Professor, publisher. (2021). Primary market research methods. [Video recording]. Business Professor. -Primary vs. Secondary Research - https://youtu.be/OeF93Q8gPsM?feature=shared
September 23rd Class #3 You must leave this meeting with a complete understanding of your company’s objectives.	F2F Management Discovery Meeting: -Confirm your client’s exact objectives. -Who are your customers? (type, market, personas) -What’s the business value your company provides? -What is the Primary and/or Secondary research? -Who are the competitors/their differentiators? -Understand what marketing they do & do not do. -The primary KPIs: revenue, marketing expenses -Know titles, cell #s, schedule your weekly meetings #2 of the 10 Rules for the Best Presentations “Be Authentic & Human.” You will be giving a 10-minute presentation on September 30th.	This meeting is during your class time. You can meet at the company, or you can schedule a classroom with the Derby Entrepreneurship Center. See me to do so Two teams can meet in our classroom that day. This is a critical meeting where you are expected to “Discover Everything” you need to know to move ahead. Your final marketing plan will be assessed based on the objectives of this meeting unless you officially update them.

Date	Primary Topics	Detailed Advice
September 30th Class #4	This is a graded presentation  -Personas and Value Propositions -Rules from TAs on timetables, notes, and dynamics -Jack: More on Primary Research -All teams: schedule time with Jack & TA this week. Jack: A.C.E. & Marketing Funnels 2:30-3:30 HubSpot: Cory Peterson, VP Sales & Marketing, LED. HubSpot & Marketing Tools: Where and how he uses his AI tools Max Kind: CAC & LTC math. #3 of the 10 Rules for the Best Presentations <u>"Live the Room."</u>	10-minute PPT presentations-each team: -Start with your agenda -What are your objectives? -Your timeline for the semester; weekly meetings? -Is there Primary research? What do you need? -Show a draft of AI-generated research questions. -What are your overall concerns on the project? -What are the tools you need? -Where do you need specific help?
October 7th Class #5 -Presentation Tactics	Jack: Primary Marketing Tactics & Tools Abem Fetene: Google AI tools 3:30 Presentation Prep with Zach Merchant, an alum from this course and now TV news anchor and political reporter for Atlanta NBC TV #4 of the 10 Rules for the Best Presentations <u>"It's All About You."</u>	Cory Peterson: -Overview of how LED uses Hubspot for Marketing -Where Hubspot sits in a tech stack for lead gen -His company's use of AI: Why? How? -What nurturing & sequencing look like in HubSpot -A/B testing using Google ads Hubspot: SEO Basics-1 Hubspot: SEO More Detail-2 Hubspot: SEO Website-3
October 14th Class #6 Mid Term	This is a graded presentation and serves as the mid-term exam in its importance! For me and your TA, this is a critical opportunity to assess where the team is relative to its expected deliverables, how the team members are functioning together and individually and if your timelines are realistic. Each team needs to schedule 30 minutes with Jack and your TA during the following week, when we will go over grades. Jack to discuss the requirements for the Calm/Headspace Case Study. Remind Me! #5 of the 10 Rules for the Best Presentations <u>"You on Stage".</u> Send any questions about your company to our speakers next week!	TEAM PRESENTATIONS -20-minute PPT presentations with Q&A -Detail your project objectives: 1-2-3 -Provide an outline of your marketing plan sections. -Detail your personas and their value props. -Revenue for 2025? Plan for 2026? Growth % for '27? -What Marketing KPI's do they have today? Your plan? -Where are you with your primary/secondary research? -Present a blog and why you have that structure/who. -What AI tools will you, why, where and how? -Describe your project deliverables in detail/week -Identify any project issues or concerns. -Present actions and timelines to be completed/week -Where are you with your primary/secondary research? Each team will provide the other six teams no later than 6:00PM, Friday, the 27th, with a one-pager as to the quality of the presentation and the presenters along with your specific recommendations. One team, one page of comments and tactics, to five teams

December 9th Class #12	2:00 Abha Gallewale, Senior Global Marketing Manager, and an alum from this class, discussing making choices in a competitive marketplace plus measuring marketing success. Final Prep for Presentations Team Pizza!	
December 14th -18th 90-minute final presentations	This final presentation does require significant coordination. On the actual day of the class of December 16th, we can schedule only two very tight presentations. One from 1:30-2:45 and one from 3:00-4:15. The other companies must be scheduled during this week. Please figure out your own scheduling locations if you cannot be one of the 2 presentations on December 16th. This is a “First Come/First Taken” for selections in our own classroom. Given the critical nature of these presentations, the length of these presentations will be approximately 90 minutes. Coordinate with my schedule and that of your TA.	Please make sure that I and your respective TA have digital copies of all your presentation materials and any materials given to your management: -Digital copies of your presentation. -Digital copies of all your other marketing materials provided to your company. -A confidential one page from everyone as to the class overall and any specific comments related to your involvement in the team and the semester’s work.

The List Below is for the Best HubSpot Content videos.

The list below consists of the specific HubSpot training videos -most of which are referenced in the syllabus above at certain dates and which you may want to use in the design of your marketing plans. While not “required” per se, you may find these very helpful.

Introductions

[HubSpot - Academy](#): Introduction to marketing Hub

[HubSpot - Academy](#): Marketing Hub

- Make my Personas Site:
[Make My Persona - Free Buyer Persona Template Generator \(2024\) \(hubspot.com\)](#)
- Segmentation
- Creating a Campaign
- CTA Creation
- Creating Forms
- Automation: workflows
- Email marketing
- Social media

Hubspot Academy: AI Tools

- [HubSpot - Academy](#): A highly recommended introduction video: AI as a strategic advantage
- [AI for Marketers](#): Excellent detailing

HubSpot Academy: Specific Tools

- [HubSpot - Academy](#): email marketing: detailed from strategy to execution.
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Nurturing leads and customers; segmentation.
 - Marketing Automation
 - Steps in creating Lead Nurturing and using automation.

[HubSpot - Academy](#): Content Marketing including video.

[HubSpot - Academy](#): Video Marketing

- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Lead generation campaign
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): SEO Basics 1
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): SEO 2
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Website SEO 3
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Social Media
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Social Media in Hubspot
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Advanced Social Media
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Social Media Advertising
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Paid search advertising
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): Fundamentals of website design
- [HubSpot - Academy](#): workflows